



DIPLOMA SUPPLEMENT

This Diploma Supplement follows the model of UNESCO-CEPES, Council of Europe, and the European Commission. It has been designed to provide a description of the nature, level, context, content and status of the studies pursued and successfully completed by the individual named on the original qualification to which this supplement is appended. It should be free from any value-judgements, equivalence statements or suggestions about recognition.

1. Information identifying the holder of the qualification

- | | | |
|-----|---------------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1.1 | Family name: | Chaudhry |
| 1.2 | Given names: | Muhammad Attique Rasheed |
| 1.3 | Date of birth (day/month/year): | 8 September 1993 |
| 1.4 | Student code: | 2308103 |
| | HESA identification number: | |

2. Information identifying the qualification

- | | | |
|-----|---|--|
| 2.1 | Name of qualification and (if applicable) title conferred: | Master of Science
The power to award degrees is regulated by law in the UK. |
| 2.2 | Main field(s) of study for the qualification: | Cybersecurity |
| 2.3 | Name and status of awarding institution: | University of Chester, recognised body |
| 2.4 | Name and status of institution (if different from 2.3) administering studies: | as above |
| 2.5 | Language(s) of instruction and examination: | Unless clear from the title in 2.2, Language of Instruction - English |



3. Information on the level of the qualification

- 3.1 HESA level of qualification:** Masters Degree not mainly by research
- 3.2 Official length of programme:** 1 year in full time mode and a maximum of 6 years in part time mode
- 3.3 Access requirement(s):**
as required by the Programme Specification. Please see www.chester.ac.uk for details

4. Information on the contents and results gained

- 4.1 Mode of study:** Full-time

4.2 Programme requirements:

The learner must satisfy the programme requirements as prescribed in the Programme Specification and the Principles and Regulations of the Institution. Please see www.chester.ac.uk for details.

4.3 Programme details and the individual grades obtained:

Programme start date 2 October 2023

Programme end date 11 October 2024

Year	Module	Title	Attempt	Credits Aim	Credits Gained	ECTS Credits	Mark	Result
2023/4	CO7100	Research Dissertation	1	60	60	30	53.0	Pass
		Poster Presentation 15%					67.0	Pass
		Research Dissertation 85%					51.0	Pass
2023/4	CO7115	Research Methods	1	20	20	10	73.0	Distinction
		Critical Review 50%					65.0	Pass
		Review Paper 50%					81.0	Pass
2023/4	CO7601	Cyber Concepts and Techniques	1	20	20	10	70.0	Distinction
		Individual Report 40%					77.0	Pass
		Portfolio 60%					66.0	Pass
2023/4	CO7602	Business Implications of Cybersecurity	2	20	20	10	50.0	Pass
		Individual Report 40%					75.0	Pass
		Group Report/Presentation 60%					72.0	Pass
2023/4	CO7605	Software Exploitation	2	20	20	10	50.0	Pass
		Group Presentation 40%					45.0	Fail
		Portfolio 60%					67.0	Pass
2023/4	CO7606	Digital Forensics and Incident Response	1	20	20	10	62.0	Merit
		Individual Report 50%					42.0	Fail
		Group Report and Presentation 50%					81.0	Pass
2023/4	CO7607	Penetration Testing and Active Defence	1	20	20	10	64.0	Merit
		Individual Report 70%					62.0	Pass



Individual Report 30%

68.0

Pass

TOTAL LEVEL 7 CREDITS

180

180

90

TOTAL CREDITS AWARDED

180

180

90

**Credits
Aim**

**Credits
Gained**

**ECTS
Credits**

FINAL TOTAL CREDITS

180

180

90

4.4 Grading scheme and if applicable grade distribution guidance:

The grading scheme used by the University is based on percentages. Components and modules are given a mark between 0% and 100%; in cases where a module is assessed on a Pass/Fail basis only the mark column in Section 4.3 will be blank.

The module pass mark is 40% in respect of Levels 3, 4, 5 and 6. The 40% pass mark also applied to Level 7 modules registered in years prior to 2019/20, with a 50% pass mark adopted for Level 7 modules from 2019/20. In respect of the information shown in 4.3, this means that Level 7 modules with a 'year' prior to 2019/20 were subject to a 40% pass mark and Level 7 modules with a 'year' from 2019/20 were subject to a 50% pass mark. This change in pass mark simply reflects the adoption of a new set of Level 7 marking criteria which aligned the pass threshold to a higher numerical mark (50 rather than 40). The standard of work required to achieve a pass did not change as a result.

The module pass mark for Level 7 modules on the MEng programme has been 50% since the programme began in September 2014.

In certain specified circumstances at levels 3, 4, 5 and 6, failure in a module may be condoned, with the module credits awarded; where condonement has been applied, a result of Condoned will be displayed.

**4.5 Overall classification of the qualification
(in original language):****5. Information on the function of the qualification****5.1 Access to further study:**

Access to Doctorate

5.2 Professional status (if applicable):

See Programme Specification

6. Additional information



6.1 Additional information:

6.2 Further information sources:

www.chester.ac.uk

7. Certification of the Diploma Supplement

7.1 Date of award:

4 December 2024

7.2 Signature:

Ian P Britton

7.3 Capacity:

Academic Registrar

7.4 Official stamp or seal:



University of
Chester

8. Information on the National Higher Education System

Description of Higher Education in England, Wales and Northern Ireland

In the United Kingdom (UK), Higher Education (HE) is a devolved matter, with political oversight provided by the UK Government and Parliament (England), the Scottish Government and Parliament (Scotland), the Welsh Government and Parliament (Wales), and the Northern Ireland Executive and Assembly (Northern Ireland). HE provision is offered by many different types of institution that are active in teaching, research, and scholarship. The term includes all publicly funded universities and other HE institutions, alternative HE providers that offer HE courses but do not receive annual public funding, and further education colleges in England and Wales, which offer HE level courses.

Degree Awarding Powers and University Title

The power to award degrees is regulated by law in the UK. Those organisations granted the power to award HE degrees are referred to as 'Recognised Bodies', and a full list of these is published by the UK Government. It is an offence for an organisation to purport to award, or to offer a UK degree, unless it is authorised to do so. Degree-awarding bodies often work with other providers that do not have degree awarding powers to deliver provision which leads to a qualification of the degree-awarding body. The Listed Bodies Order confirms the providers that do not have the powers to award their own degrees, but offer programmes that lead to a degree of a Recognised Body (see <https://www.gov.uk/check-a-university-is-officially-recognised>).

Qualifications

Previously there were two parallel frameworks for HE qualifications of UK degree-awarding bodies, one that applied to Scotland and one that operates in the rest of the UK:

- The Framework for Higher Education Qualifications of Degree-Awarding Bodies in England, Wales and Northern Ireland (FHEQ)
- The Framework for Qualifications of Higher Education Institutions in Scotland (FQHEIS).

These frameworks were the principal national reference points for academic standards in UK HE. However, providers in England, who are no longer required to use the FHEQ, now have to meet the Office for Students' conditions of registration and align their qualifications with the OfS' [sector recognised standards](#). These sector-recognised standards do not formally reference the QF-EHEA or the other frameworks in use across the UK. Consequently two tables, provided by the QAA on behalf of the UK and Ireland Qualifications Frameworks and Policy Group, are now provided for use within the HEAR to support providers to align UK qualifications with the QF-EHEA.

Quality Assurance

Academic standards are established and maintained by HE institutions themselves, using an extensive and sophisticated range of shared quality assurance approaches and structures. Standards and quality in institutions are underpinned by the use of external examiners, standards agreed and recognised by the sector, by the activities of the Quality Assurance Agency for Higher Education (QAA) in Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland, by the Office for Students in England and in professional areas by relevant professional, statutory and regulatory bodies.

The sector standards are supported by the [Quality Council for UK Higher Education](#), formed from partner organisations, providers and national HE regulators.

A cornerstone of quality arrangements across all four nations is the UK Quality Code for Higher Education. It is a key reference point in the quality approaches for Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland

In England, providers need to comply with the [Office for Students' Regulatory Framework and Conditions of Registration](#). Engaging with the Quality Code is voluntary for providers based in England, except for those providers reviewed against the Quality Code using the Educational Oversight Review (EOR) method

England

The Higher Education and Research Act 2017 (HERA) drives the regulatory and legal requirements of HE in England. The legislation can be found at <http://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2017/29/contents/enacted>. This Act established the Office for Students (OfS) and gave it responsibility for regulating the English HE sector. Its primary focus is the student interest in its duty as a market regulator. The OfS is responsible for risk-based monitoring of indicators relating to the baseline quality and standards of provision. It maintains the Register of HE providers in England, and implemented a regulatory framework in February 2018: <https://www.officeforstudents.org.uk/publications/securing-student-success-regulatory-framework-for-higher-education-in-england/>.

Degree-awarding bodies in England must be registered with the OfS and meet all ongoing conditions of registration in order to retain degree-awarding powers. The OfS has express powers to revoke degree-awarding powers for HE providers in England if conditions of registration are not maintained.

Northern Ireland

Funding for HE is directly provided by the Department for the Economy in Northern Ireland.

QAA has been commissioned by the Department for the Economy (DfE) to develop an enhancement-led quality review method for higher education in Northern Ireland.

The new review method will provide confidence to DfE, students, staff and the public in the quality of higher education provision in Northern Ireland, whilst supporting higher education institutions to enhance the quality of the student academic experience. The review method is being developed in collaboration with the higher education sector in Northern Ireland and QAA expects to produce a proposal paper on the new review method for DfE by September 2024.

Scotland

The Scottish Funding Council (SFC), a non-departmental public body, is the strategic body responsible for funding Scotland's teaching and learning provision and research. Scotland takes an enhancement-led approach to quality assurance with its Tertiary Quality Enhancement Framework (TQEF), which focuses on the whole student experience and its enhancement rather than on quality assurance alone. This is built on partnership and collective engagement between a number of bodies including the Scottish Funding Council, QAA Scotland, the National Union of Students (NUS), and Universities Scotland. The TQEF requires both rigorous institutional activity, using external reference points, and external review on a seven-year cycle, known as Tertiary Quality Enhancement Review (TQER.) Institutions must demonstrate how they meet the expectations of the Quality Code, which is confirmed as a formal part of TQER.

Wales

The Higher Education Funding Council for Wales (HEFCW) is the Welsh Government sponsored body responsible for regulating the Welsh HE sector. From 1 August 2024, HEFCW will be replaced by a new Welsh Government sponsored body, the Commission for Tertiary Education and Research which will be responsible for overseeing post-16 education and research in Wales. The QAA undertakes Quality Enhancement Reviews of regulated HE providers every six years under the Wales Quality Assessment Framework. For more information, see: <https://www.qaa.ac.uk/reviewing-higher-education/types-of-review/quality-enhancement-review>.

The Commission will be working to the same 6-year cycle – arrangements with QAA to continue as they are for at least the next couple of years up to the point when CTER gain the powers to consider the option of appointing a designated quality body.

Credit Systems

A number of integrated credit frameworks operate within the UK: the Scottish Credit and Qualifications Framework ([SCQF](#)) and the Credit and Qualifications Framework for Wales ([CQFW](#)), both of which are underpinned by the same principles, such as the definition of one credit as 10 notional hours of learning.

The [FHEQ](#) is a qualifications framework, based on the outcomes represented by the main qualification titles; it is not an integrated credit and qualifications framework, nor does its use depend on the use of credit. Not all degree-awarding bodies in England use credit in the same way, therefore. Some may not use credit at all, and some may use the European Credit Transfer and Accumulation System (ECTS) to support student mobility within Europe and award ECTS points rather than UK credit. Nevertheless, credit is widely used by most degree-awarding bodies in the UK. An advisory [Higher Education credit framework for England](#) has been in use since 2008. The credit framework is written for HE providers in England as a description of the typical practice developed across the sector and to provide a reference point for those wishing to introduce or consolidate their use of credit. The SCQF and the CQFW are integrated credit and qualifications frameworks, which means that they specify minimum credit volumes and levels for qualifications. The SCQF embraces all educational sectors, with the FQHEIS as a constituent part; and the CQFW is a meta- framework for credit and qualifications in Wales, embracing all post-14 education and training, and treating the FHEQ as a constituent part. The credit arrangements in the FQHEIS/SCQF apply to all degree-awarding bodies in Scotland. All degree-awarding bodies in Wales have agreed to use the credit arrangements stipulated in the CQFW, in relation to the FHEQ.

Admission

UK HE providers determine their own admissions policies and the minimum entry requirements for each programme. For Bachelor's degrees, the minimum entry requirement is usually two or three General Certificate of Education Advanced-level (GCE A level) passes, as well as a minimum number of General Certificate of Secondary Education (GCSE) passes at grade C or above. These remain the most common form of entry qualification held by young entrants to HE. Other appropriate qualifications may also provide entry, e.g. the International Baccalaureate, the Welsh Baccalaureate, Scottish Highers, Advanced Highers, or qualifications at the same levels of the Scottish Credit and Qualifications Framework and Edexcel BTEC National Qualifications. The Universities and Colleges Admissions System (UCAS) tariff establishes comparability between different types of qualification across the UK using a points system.

The Access to Higher Education Diploma provides another route for mature entrants. Most institutions also welcome applications from mature candidates who have had appropriate experience but may lack formal qualifications, offering credit for prior study and informal learning acquired through work or other experiences (Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)).



Comparing Qualifications in the UK

The table compares qualifications across the UK, providing examples of major qualifications at each level. For more details, refer to the website given at the head of each column.

Framework for higher education qualifications in England, Wales and Northern Ireland www.qaa.ac.uk		Regulated Qualifications Framework for England and Northern Ireland www.ofqual.gov.uk www.ccea.org.uk		Credit and Qualifications Framework for Wales www.cqfw.net		Scottish Credit and Qualifications Framework www.scqf.org.uk	
LEVEL		LEVEL		LEVEL		LEVEL	
8	Doctoral Degree	8	Vocational, Technical and Professional Qualifications	8	Doctoral Degree, Vocational Qualifications	12	Doctoral Degree, Professional Apprenticeship, Professional Development Award (PDA), Award
7	Master's Degree, Integrated Master's Degree, Postgraduate Diploma, Postgraduate Certificate in Education (PGCE), Postgraduate Certificate	7	Vocational, Technical and Professional Qualifications	7	Master's Degree, Vocational Qualifications, Postgraduate Certificate in Education (PGCE)	11	Master's Degree, Integrated Master's Degree, Postgraduate Diploma, Postgraduate Certificate, Professional Apprenticeship, Graduate Apprenticeship PDA, SVQ, Award
6	Bachelor's Degree with Honours, Bachelor's Degree, Professional Graduate Certificate in Education (PGCE), Graduate Diploma, Graduate Certificate	6	Vocational, Technical and Professional Qualifications	6	Honours Degree, Vocational Qualifications, Professional Certificate in Education	10	Bachelor's Degree with Honours, Graduate Diploma, Graduate Certificate, Professional Apprenticeship, Graduate Apprenticeship, PDA, SVQ, Award
5	Foundation Degree, Diploma of Higher Education (DipHE), Higher National Diploma (HND)	5	Vocational, Technical and Professional Qualifications, Higher National Diploma (HND)	5	Foundation Degree, Vocational Qualifications, Higher National Diploma (HND)	9	Bachelor's/Ordinary Degree, Graduate Diploma, Graduate Certificate, Graduate Apprenticeship, Technical Apprenticeship, PDA, SVQ, Award
4	Higher National Certificate (HNC), Certificate of Higher Education (CertHE)	4	Vocational, Technical and Professional Qualifications, Higher National Certificate (HNC)	4	Higher National Certificate (HNC), Certificate of Higher Education (CertHE), Vocational Qualifications	8	Higher National Diploma (HND), Diploma of Higher Education (DipHE), Technical Apprenticeship, Higher Apprenticeship, PDA, SVQ, Award
3	Access to HE Diploma*	3	Vocational, Technical and Professional Qualifications, GCE AS and A Level	3	Welsh Baccalaureate Advanced, Vocational Qualifications, GCE, AS and A Level, Access to HE	7	Higher National Certificate (HNC), Certificate of Higher Education (CertHE), Modern Apprenticeship, PDA, SVQ, Scottish Baccalaureate, Advanced Higher, Award
The Access to HE Diploma is regulated by QAA but is not part of the FHEQ		2	Vocational & Technical Qualifications, GCSE at grade A-C and grade 9-4, Functional Skills (England), Essential Skills Qualification (NI)	2	Welsh Baccalaureate National, Vocational Qualifications, Essential Skills Wales Qualifications, GCSE at grade A*-C	6	Higher, Modern Apprenticeship, Foundation Apprenticeship, National Progression Award (NPA), National Certificate, PDA, SVQ, Award
		1	Vocational & Technical Qualifications, GCSE at grade D-G and grade 3-1, Functional Skills (England), Essential Skills Qualifications (NI)	1	Welsh Baccalaureate Foundation, Vocational Qualifications, Essential Skills Wales Qualifications, GCSE at grade D-G	5	National 5, Modern Apprenticeship, SVQ, NPA, National Certificate, Award
		Entry Level	Entry Level Certificate (sub levels 1-3), Functional Skills (England), Essential Skills Qualifications (NI)	Entry Level	Entry Level Qualifications, Essential Skills Qualifications	4	National 4, SVQ, NPA, National Certificate Award
						3	National 3, NPA, National Certificate, Award
						2	National 2, NPA, National Certificate, Award
						1	National 1, Award

Please note that the Credit and Qualifications Framework for Wales incorporates the Framework for Higher Education Qualifications of Degree-Awarding Bodies in England, Wales and Northern Ireland (FHEQ); the Scottish Credit and Qualifications Framework incorporates the Framework for Higher Education Qualifications of Higher Education Institutions in Scotland (FQHEIS).

Information correct at time of printing – September 2020.